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What Jeffrey Epstein Taught Peter Thiel and Steve Bannon

Branko Marcetic on the fake populism of a sordid elite.

JEET HEER



Peter Thiel speaks at The Cambridge Union on May 08, 2024 in Cambridge, Cambridgeshire (Nordin Catic / Getty Images)

The late Jeffrey Epstein was friends with all sorts of elite figures in the United States and many other countries. This extensive network is now sometimes described as “the Epstein class.” The question is, was this class held together merely by the opportunistic trading of favors or did it have a coherent worldview and agenda?

Branko Marcetic has written a series of articles in *Jacobin* that clarify this issue by looking at relationships Epstein had with the billionaire Peter Thiel and the political operative Steve Bannon.

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Jeet Heer is a national affairs correspondent for *The Nation* and host of the weekly *Nation* podcast, *The Time of Monsters*. He also pens the monthly column “Morbid Symptoms.” The author of *In Love with Art: Francoise Mouly’s Adventures in Comics with Art Spiegelman* (2013) and *Sweet Lechery: Reviews, Essays and Profiles* (2014), Heer has written for numerous publications, including *The New Yorker*, *The Paris Review*, *Virginia Quarterly Review*, *The American Prospect*, *The Guardian*, *The New Republic*, and *The Boston Globe*.